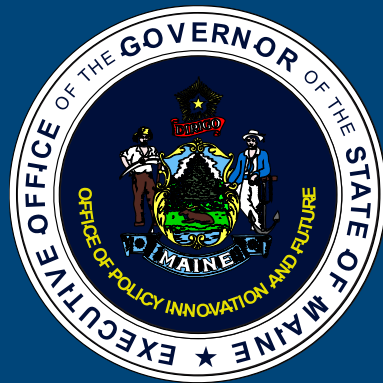




MAINE

RURAL HEALTH TRANSFORMATION



Rural Health Transformation Program

Advisory Committee

August 5, 2026

RHTTP Status Updates

RHTP Staff

RHTP Core Team

Director – [Kristen McAuley](#)

Deputy Director – Laura Beaumont (8/31 start)

AD Budget & Compliance – [Tyler Backus](#)

AD Data & Evaluation – [Debbie Bryant](#)

Initiative Leads:

- Population Health – [Eve Allen](#)
- Technology & Innovation – [Annie Arnzen](#)
- Workforce – [Leigh Arsenault](#)
- Access – Interviewing
- Sustainability – [Ann Mukherjee](#)

RHTP Extended Team

AOR / DHHS Director of Program

Implementation – [Margaret Reynolds](#)

Senior Advisor – [Lisa Letourneau](#)

Senior Advisor – [Abby Stivers](#)

Senior Advisor – [Andrew Eppich](#)

Senior Advisor – [Ben Mann](#)

Maine's Five RHTP Initiatives

Year One - Initiative “Launch”

Year One “Launch” Timeline & Documentation

- Year One reporting will be inclusive of activities to 7/31
- Population Health: [Blog](#) posted regarding partnership with UNE
- Access & Sustainability:
 - Hospital Efficiency cohort invitation letters sent + [press release](#)
 - APM Transition email sent

Initiative 1: Population Health

Empower rural Mainers to achieve their own healthy living goals: Adopt and expand proven population health solutions that promote timely access to high-quality preventive, primary, chronic, and specialty care across the lifespan.

Proposed Activities

- Expand alternative sites of care (Mobile Health, CCBHC, **SBHC**)
- **Deploy evidence-based practices**
- Strengthen rural Maine's nutrition education infrastructure
- **Expand Community Paramedicine programs (RFA open)**
- Expand **Community Health Worker** and Peer Support programs
- Support access to mental health and SUD support

Initiative 2: Workforce

Expand the Supply of Care: Grow Maine's rural health care workforce across continuum of care

Proposed Activities

- Train, recruit, and retain health care clinicians and allied health professionals
- Strengthen local talent pipelines (RFA open)
- Develop and deploy a Healthcare Workforce Data Dashboard
- Invest in mobile training labs and simulation centers
- Pilot new models in rural workforce transportation

Initiative 3: Technology Innovation

Expand the Supply of Care: Spread technology & innovation that connects every community to advanced care

Proposed Activities

- Expand telehealth services, supports, and infrastructure
- Support data integration and the reliable exchange of healthcare data
- Expand the use of consumer-facing health technology tools
- Enhance Electronic Medical Records (EMR) systems (applications due 8/14)
- Create a Maine Rural AI Hub to support rural providers in adopting today's AI technologies
- Establish a Rural Health AI Innovation Institute to promote development of new AI technologies purpose-built for rural populations

Initiative 4: Access

Ensure care will be available & affordable: Support access to healthcare for rural Mainers otherwise unable to afford it

Proposed Activities

- ~~• Issue provider payments for uncompensated care delivered by FQHCs, hospitals, and CCBHCs*~~
- ~~• Issue provider payments for provision of Essential Health Benefits to uninsured population*~~
- Implement more efficient and user-friendly MaineCare Provider Enrollment technology
- Improve coordination and leveraging of existing transportation infrastructure to assist rural Mainers to meet their health needs through technology and mobility planning
- Improve consumer-friendly transparency tool on state-based marketplace to improve access to and create competition for more affordable care plan options

**NOTE: These two activities were included in Maine's original proposal but were not allowed by CMS; Maine has moved funds for these activities to Initiative 5: Sustainable Rural Health Ecosystems*

Initiative 5: Sustainable Rural Health Ecosystem

Ensure care will be available & affordable: Ensure a sustainable rural health care ecosystem by addressing persistent financial instability facing rural healthcare systems

Proposed Activities

- Improve hospital financial stability through tailored hospital financial management, planning and targeted investment
- Conduct rural regional health ecosystems planning and implementation
- Develop and provide support for providers to participate in multi-payer alternative payment (APM) models; this will include funding specifically to support providers' work to transition to Advanced Payment Models (APMs).
- Strengthen Maine's interfacility non-emergency transport system
- ~~Expand access to high acuity, non-inpatient hospital care for children with complex behavioral health needs (PRTF)~~

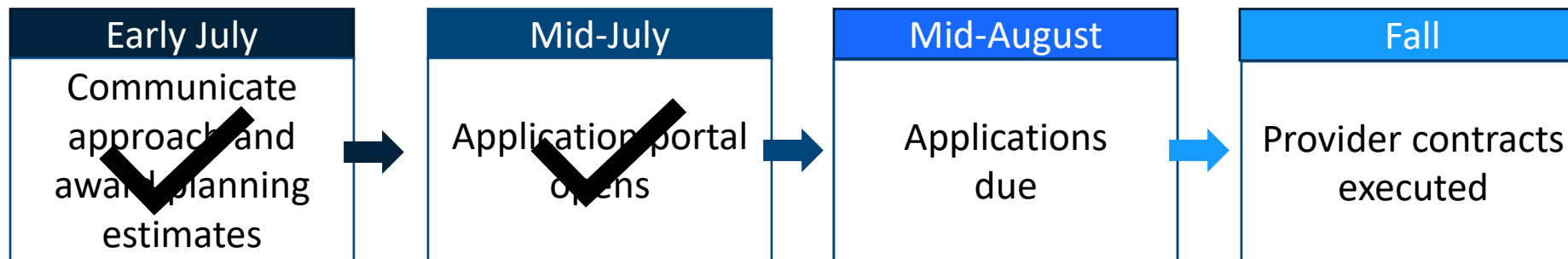
Red font indicates funding opportunities to become available in YR1 for eligible Provider organizations

Year 1 Provider Funding Opportunities

Provider Funding: EMR Funding Timelines & Details

Overview of Approach

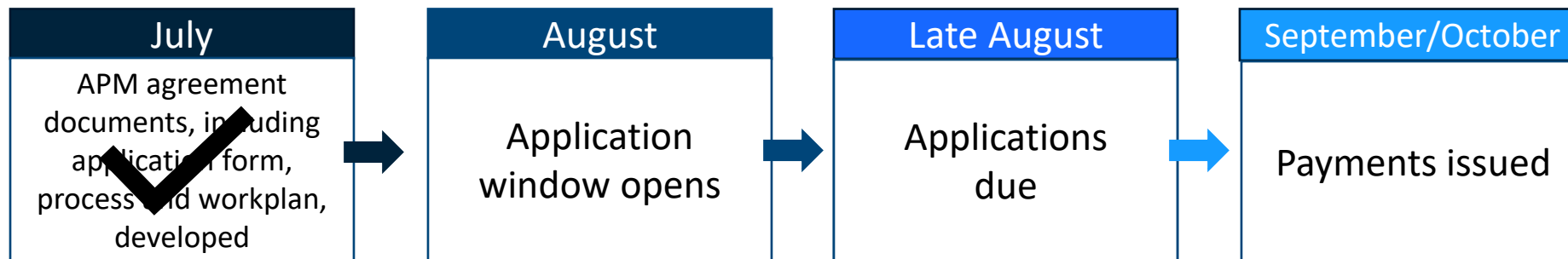
- Identified ~70 eligible ownership organizations with ~330 sites.
- Award amounts will be based on the number of eligible sites and whether those sites are located in rural areas (Rural sites receive approximately 50% higher funding than comparable non-rural sites.)



Provider Funding: APM Funding Timelines & Details

Overview of Approach

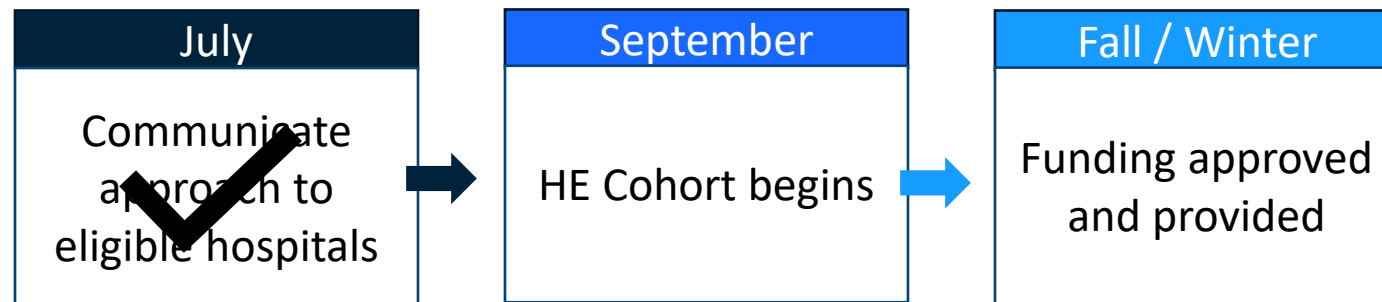
- Identified 58 eligible ownership organizations.
- Award amounts will be based uncompensated care provided in the most recently available year. Providers will need to submit a “readiness assessment,” developed by OMS, and submit a workplan, reviewed by OMS.
- Providers will receive lump sum payments based on a table of allowable expenses.



Provider Funding: Rural Hospital Efficiency Fund Timelines & Details

Overview of Approach

- Eligible hospitals to participate in this cohort identified.
- Award amount and approved budget will be confirmed after start of participation in the HE Cohort; technical assistance will be provided by consultants who are approved by DHHS and OAHC.



Provider Funding: RHEF Year 1 Cohort Mapped

Hospital NOFO Rural
Status

Rural +
Not Rural +

RHEF Cohort Hospital

